

*feeling sorry for the poor woman who had to get her reading material from a recycling bin. I caught David's eye and nodded to him that I was done for the day.*

Together, David and I are learning what we can do without, what we really need, and all the fun stuff we can get for free. I like being thrifty with my husband and would love to get a government grant to study the effects of couponing and refunding on the average marriage. Surely someone who has seen you bent over digging through a recycling bin and has not only stayed with you, but joined in, must love you a great deal.

*I took hold of David's hand as he started the car and leaned over to kiss me. "We got a good haul today," he said, glancing in the back at the boxes brimming with coupon inserts, magazines, and detergent boxes. He sighed with contentment as we drove out the entrance of the recycling center. I looked at him with appreciation, and then saw his face change from pleasure to that of surprise as he looked in the rearview mirror. He abruptly braked, then pointed back to the recycling center. "Look," he whispered. I turned to see the older couple facing each other across the same newspaper bin David and I had shared a tender moment at just minutes before. The woman was gesturing excitedly to her husband, waving a stray coupon insert in front of him. He laughed and caressed her cheek lovingly. I looked at David, and we didn't even need to voice the thought we were both having . . .*

*That's us, in twenty-five years.*

After his death, I had to wonder: without David at my side, did I even want to continue couponing? Was it worth my time and the effort involved? When the *Extreme Couponing* producers contacted me in April of 2012 and suggested they cover my true couponing love story as a human interest